

Bloomberg Daily Briefing — Saturday, August 1, 2026

Markets & Central Banks

- **US joins Japan to engineer yen rebound** — Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent joined Japanese authorities in coordinated intervention aimed at reversing months of yen losses, a slide that has stoked inflation in Japan and rippled through global markets. The joint push marks one of the most notable rebounds in the currency since its slump began.
- **Fed's silence has S&P traders bracing for wild swings** — With war, tariff fights and sticky inflation already challenging investors, markets now must price a Federal Reserve that is giving little forward guidance. Chairman Kevin Warsh's communications stance is deepening uncertainty around the rate path.
- **Warsh weighing fewer Fed policy meetings** — A proposal to reduce the number of scheduled Fed meetings drew concern from economists and strategists, who warn fewer decision points could make policy moves more disruptive and increase market volatility.
- **Central banks hold rates steady across the board** — Policymakers from the US, UK and Japan left rates unchanged this week, assessing renewed inflation risks from higher energy costs and war in the Middle East.
- **Bessent misses chance to coordinate with a China-wary Europe** — A Bloomberg Opinion analysis argues Washington is going it alone on trade strategy when a unified approach with Europe was available, leaving US and EU policy on China increasingly divergent.

Geopolitics: Middle East & Ukraine

- **US embassies warn Americans as Iran threatens more choke points** — Embassies across the Middle East urged caution after President Trump said he was considering new military strikes against Iran, keeping Gulf shipping risk elevated.
- **Qatari LNG tanker struck while transiting Hormuz** — A tanker carrying LNG from Qatar was hit by a projectile in the Strait of Hormuz, according to security firms and ship tracking, threatening to further disrupt deliveries of super-chilled fuel through the key waterway.
- **Hamas disarmament plan tests Israel's next move** — Israel is weighing a Hamas-backed disarmament proposal as Netanyahu prepares to bring the Trump-backed Gaza road map to cabinet, with questions over sequencing, Israeli withdrawal and Palestinian governance.
- **Ukraine hits Russian refineries as Kyiv faces missile barrage** — Russia fired ballistic missiles and drones at Ukraine's capital overnight, killing at least nine,

while Kyiv's forces struck oil facilities deep inside Russian territory — a continuation of the mutual energy-infrastructure campaign.

- **Israel election puts Netanyahu under pressure** — Challenger Gadi Eisenkot is gaining support, leaving Netanyahu entering the campaign in a vulnerable position even as he remains a formidable opponent.

Global Macro

- **South Korea's exports extend momentum as chip boom persists** — July exports posted another month of strong growth, reinforcing that AI-driven demand continues to underpin the economy and strengthening the case for further monetary tightening.
- **Germany's economic revival within touching distance** — Europe's largest economy is finally showing signs the long-awaited recovery is coming into view after years of stagnation.
- **Romania narrowly averts junk rating on debt** — Romania avoided a downgrade to junk status, but its acting finance chief called the near-miss a warning to resolve political deadlock and press on with budget reforms.
- **Peru's inflation tops forecasts** — Headline inflation in Lima accelerated faster than expected in July as food and transport prices climbed, staying above target for a fifth straight month.
- **Rising fuel prices hit Americans without tax refunds to tap** — After consumers powered through an earlier fuel spike with the help of federal tax refunds, a new wave of higher gasoline prices arrives with that buffer gone, squeezing household budgets.

Energy & Commodities

- **Exxon and Chevron warn fuel prices to endure as war knocks refining** — Even if oil prices fall, high fuel prices are likely to persist because wars in Russia and the Middle East have left global refining capacity critically short.
- **Turkey extends Iraq oil pipeline deal by one year** — Turkey agreed to extend an expired pipeline agreement with Iraq and increase flows, securing supply through a route that bypasses the Strait of Hormuz.
- **Singapore Airlines records 10.9 million passengers but Iran war still causes loss** — Record passenger numbers and revenue could not offset a spike in fuel costs triggered by the regional conflict.
- **Glencore pursues legal fight over \$230 million in unpaid oil** — The commodity trader says it was duped into supplying crude to a now-insolvent refinery and is pursuing recovery through the courts.

Politics

- **Burnham bets a Trump-style show buys time to fix the hard stuff** — Andy Burnham's first two weeks as UK prime minister brought a policy blitz on social care, devolution and the cost of living; inside Downing Street, aides admit the announcements were as much about politics as policy.
- **Sánchez isolated over Spain's migration crisis** — Spain's PM, the most progressive European leader on migration, is politically exposed after thousands of migrants overran the enclave of Ceuta; Madrid slammed "selfish, polarizing and unlawful" responses from some EU states.
- **Hungary heads toward nuclear shutdown** — Record-low Danube River levels threaten a full shutdown of Hungary's sole nuclear plant, straining energy supplies and testing new Prime Minister Peter Magyar's government.
- **India youth protests shake Modi government** — The youth-led "Cockroach Movement," fueled by exam paper leaks and rising unemployment, forced the resignation of the education minister and is gaining momentum.
- **Trump pushes \$1.8 billion DOJ fund** — Trump doubled down on the fund for supporters, saying he'd work with Congress to make it federal law even if it costs him his attorney general nominee.
- **Bipartisan governors launch immigration task force** — A bipartisan group of governors is developing policy recommendations for Congress on immigration, seeking common ground amid deep federal divides.
- **US soldier rejects Polymarket Maduro wager charges** — A soldier charged with betting on Polymarket using classified information about the Maduro raid is asking a judge to throw out the case, calling the alleged bets "overzealous" prosecution.

Technology

- **AI isn't a catch-all trade this earnings season** — Equity investors are learning that not all artificial intelligence trades are created equal, with the AI trade now discriminating between winners and losers.
- **Can Africa power the AI boom?** — Teraco CEO Jan Hnizdo argues Africa is becoming a key data-center destination, with energy and sustainability set to determine the continent's digital future.
- **Can mergers close Europe's tech gap?** — The EU is rewriting its merger rules for the first time in two decades to create business "champions" able to compete with the US, with debate over how far competition policy should bend for scale.

Corporate

- **FIFA faces backlash over investment plan** — FIFA President Gianni Infantino withdrew plans to sell a stake in the World Cup after opposition from UEFA and

other soccer leaders, as critics question the need for the multibillion-dollar capital raise.

- **The father of 401(k) has a new retirement plan** — Ted Benna co-created "Radish," an employer-funded retirement plan allowing employees to tap funds for immediate needs like car repairs or medical expenses without paycheck deductions.

Sources: Bloomberg Markets, Economics, Business, Politics, Technology and Wealth RSS feeds. Articles summarized are limited to RSS-lede content; full text may carry additional detail behind Bloomberg's paywall. This briefing is for informational purposes only and does not constitute investment advice.

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